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I am an operations executive with governance experience, and spent >20 years in international general management and programme leadership roles in mostly the B2B SaaS and iNGO sectors, but also in production and retail. I have set up, grown, streamlined, integrated, carved out, downsized and closed mid-sized companies and large business units, and led multiple change projects, both in the area of organisational culture and design as well as in technology implementations. I am a versatile and pragmatic person with grit and an entrepreneurial mindset. I value team work, inclusion, strong governance, transparency and accountability.

KEY SKILLS

- People and Performance (OKR, Executive Reporting), Leadership
- Strategy Definition and Execution
- Business Transformation, Programme Management, Organisational Design
- Stakeholder Engagement, Relationship Management, Partnership Management

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

💎 Performance Improvement	💎 Change Management	💎 Implementation Projects
<i>Dow Jones</i> - Demonstrably improved business performance through alignment of multiple functional areas and increased transparency via integrated analyses of P&L, product roadmaps, customer satisfaction and cost management.	<i>Médecins sans Frontières</i> - Curved an inward looking culture by applying corporate best practices, establishing solid project management principles for strategic oversight, and improving design of the Supply, HR and Technology functions.	<i>Elsevier</i> - Transformed fragmented scientist services into a single, modern self-serve platform. Also improved the capability to innovate through the set-up of a company in India to co-create digitization initiatives with long-standing partners.

EXPERIENCE

05-2024 / present

Freelance Interim Manager / Fractional Leader / Non-Executive Director

- Interim Director of Finance & Operations (Amsterdam): completed financial separation of new legal entities, improved working relationships between new management teams, fleshed out complex agreements between fundraising members in the Netherlands, UK, U.S., Germany and Sweden, and provided leadership to Finance, Technology, Legal and Procurement teams.
- Prepared and delivered a strategy session for 20+ senior managers, followed up by an extensive report including recommendations for strategic direction and priorities (London).
- As a founding member of C-Suites Lab I provide strategic advice to CEOs/Founders, co-create our service portfolio and am a driving force within the community (Barcelona).

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- 01-2021 / 04-2024** **VP Business Operations at Dow Jones (Barcelona, ES)**
 ✦ *Reporting to GM B2B Risk & Research, member of the Leadership Team, revenue \$400m+ in SaaS products*
 Appointed for thought leadership, value proposition, pricing and content strategy, I identified the need to improve business performance and risk management, and created the BizOps role. Through laborious stakeholder engagement and creation of solid OKR frameworks and reporting, I improved collaboration between the business and support teams. I also steered my peers responsible for Product Management and Commercial Strategy, and led the annual strategy and budget planning.
- 04-2018 / 12-2020** **Vice President Data & Content Management at Dow Jones (Barcelona, ES)**
 ✦ *Reporting to Head of Data Strategy, support function, 100 staff across Americas, EMEA and APAC*
 Directed the content, research and market data teams that power consumer products like the Wall Street Journal, and B2B SaaS products like Factiva (news monitoring platform) and VentureSource (for VC and private market data). My young management team and I ditched the traditional hierarchical ways of working and started to drive real collaborations and improvements, and introduced concepts like operational excellence. I managed job losses following the acquisition of VentureSource by CB Insights and the integration into DJ systems of a new market data provider.
- 02-2014 / 02-2018** **Director Projects, Resources & Organisation (COO) at Médecins sans Frontières (Amsterdam, NL)**
 ✦ *Reporting to General Director, member of the Management Team, 170 staff, \$260M*
 Provided leadership for Finance, HR, Technology, Supply Chain, Technical Logistics and other teams. I set up a PMO to improve tracking of all strategic projects and positioned Technology as a value-adding business partner, separated Run and Build to improve service delivery to our teams in the field. I implemented MS Dynamics to replace standalone spreadsheets and an effective information management to accelerate onboarding of field staff.
- 01-2008 / 01-2013** **Vice President Editorial Systems at Elsevier ([RELX Group](#), Amsterdam, NL)**
 ✦ *Reporting to EVP Operations, member of the Operations Management Team, 40 staff + 80 FTE outsourced, \$1.2M and \$30M CapEx*
 Upon board approval of my business case, I converted fragmented and outdated author, editor and reviewer services into a state-of-the-art self-serve platform serving millions of scientists worldwide supported by a uniform, global team. This entailed the set-up of a PMO to oversee the activities of both internal project staff and 3rd party teams, both on-site and in India, and an iterative design process involving an Advisory Board consisting of prominent Editors-in-Chief as well as branding and marketing efforts. At the same time, multiple legacy systems and their respective support teams remained fully operational whilst preparing to adopt new ways of working (ITIL, SLAs and QA).
- 09-2006 / 12-2007** **Managing Director Elsevier India in Chennai, India**
 ✦ *Reporting to EVP Operations, member of the Operations Management Team, growing staff base from 0 to 60*
 Following Board approval of my business case, which aimed to boost innovation through a joint venture with our Indian partners and paid for by labour arbitrage advantages following the offshoring of production work carried out in U.S. and European offices, I was asked to establish this presence in India. I built the Indian

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office from scratch and succeeded in delivering all year-1 objectives, including the lease and fit out of an office and meeting all statutory obligations. I was awarded the “Elsevier Exceptional Achievement Award” and the “Elsevier Operational Excellence Award” by the CEO for the development and successful execution of this initiative.

- 10-2005 / 08-2006** **Integration Manager Elsevier Health Europe** in Barcelona, ES
✦ *Reporting to EVP Operations, member of the Operations Management Team, working as a Project Manager with a clear mandate*
Following my contributions to the Due Diligence team, I was asked to integrate newly acquired companies in France and Italy (Masson) and Spain (Doyma) in Elsevier’s production, fulfilment and distribution organisations.
- 10-2004 / 09-2005** **Global Director Customer Service & Fulfilment Elsevier (Oxford, UK)**
Introduction of Lean Six Sigma. Leading teams in San Diego, St. Louis, Orland, Oxford, Amsterdam and Singapore.
- 09-2000 / 09-2004** **Managing Director Elsevier Ireland Ltd (Shannon, IRE)**
I increased production volume by 30% in conjunction with a 10% efficiency gain, reduced the cost base by 10% whilst increasing the number of staff from 90 to 120 FTE. As a leading office for innovation, I also established Global Services and Support teams.
- 03-1993 / 08-2000** **HR Director at Interface Fashion B.V., Northprint & Krips and PBNA**
Managed site closures, union negotiations, harmonization of compensation & benefits, integration of HR teams

NED ROLES

Caroll Heinemann Ltd, Butterworths Ireland Ltd, IWPM (Holdings) Ltd, Shannon Community Workshop (2000-2004)
Médecins sans Frontières Netherlands - Vice-President, Chair of Remuneration Committee, member of the Audit & Risk Committee (2020-2022)

EDUCATION

BA (Hons) Communication, University of Applied Sciences, Economics & Management (Utrecht, NL)
Finance & Accounting, The Wharton School (Philadelphia, US)
Management Development, Templeton College (Oxford, UK)
Leadership Programme, Babson College (Boston, US)

REFERENCES

Sarah McLaughlin - Director, Partners & Alliances at Dow Jones, June 2024
“...Els’ strategic thinking, efficiency and extensive project management knowledge were pivotal to our success... Her clear communication and diplomatic approach ensured everyone met their responsibilities and their deadlines...”

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Joe Cappitelli - General Manager of Dow Jones Newswires, April 2024

"...Els is very organized and analytical and always had a positive 'can do' attitude for even the most daunting of projects. She is a strong leader, helped foster an environment of collaboration, and contributed significantly to the positive team culture we have built at Dow Jones..."

John Edeson - Head of Product Management Risk & Compliance at Dow Jones, April 2024

"...Ever civil and friendly, I always enjoyed my interaction with Els and her team. It was clear that she infused that friendly but hard-working approach to her team as well. Meetings were never longer than they had to be, actions were clear and I found her a pleasure to work with..."

Manon Frenken - Independent HR/OD Professional, December 2017

"...Els demonstrated a great versatility and adaptability... As a line manager she is inclusive, empowering and stimulating to think of alternative ways forward. I appreciate her sense of humour, strength and courage".

Gerrit Bos - Business Consultant, January 2013

"...Whatever big change management job you have in mind for her, Els knows how to succeed. She is an excellent people manager and executor, she is honest and direct, but sensitive to the human side of any management decision as well. She is also a great team player..."

Sreeram Pamidighantam - Vice President and Sector Growth Leader North America at Wipro Limited, January 2013

"...An entrepreneurial leader with 3 significant strengths: 1/ an ability to combine strategy and execution with an attention to detail, 2/ inclusive approach to stakeholders and staff, 3/ being accessible despite having a demanding schedule. She would rate among the top decile leaders of the publishing industry."

Berengere Williams - Head of FP&A at Envestnet Inc, October 2012

"...The scope of Els' technical and soft skills is very broad... one of the best leaders I have ever interacted with..."

Further references upon request.